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FREEDOM NOW!

I have had many experiences in my relatively young life, but I have never in my life had an experience like I am having in Birmingham, Alabama. This is the most inspiring movement that has ever taken place in the United States of America.

APRIL 19, 1963
King and Ralph Abernathy are released on bond

MAY 2–7
Birmingham police use fire hoses and dogs against "Children's Crusade"; over 1,000 youngsters arrested

MAY 8
Protest leaders suspend mass demonstrations

MAY 11
After tentative settlement is reached, segregationists bomb the Gaston Motel where King was staying and the home of King's brother, the Reverend A. D. King

MAY 13
Federal troops arrive in Birmingham

After eight days of imprisonment, Ralph Abernathy and I accepted bond to come out of jail for two purposes. It was necessary for me to regain communication with the SCLC officers and our lawyers in order to map the strategy for the contempt cases that would be coming up shortly in the circuit court. Also, I had decided to put into operation a new phase of our campaign, which I felt would speed victory.

I called my staff together and repeated a conviction I had been voicing ever since the campaign began. If our drive was to be successful, we must involve the students of the community. Even though we realized that involving teenagers and high school students would bring down upon us a